

delta patch updates. Using deltas for package updates means smaller downloads, because the complete updated packages aren't required any more. Instead, only the patches that have been applied in the new version are downloaded and put in place to make the system up to date.

- Empathy now replaces Pidgin (which is still available in the repository as an option) as the

(read more at www.linuxforu.com/reviews/fedora11-review/), the obvious choice this time was the DVD. The size of the DVD was a mere 3GB—much less than what you get from the Mandriva and openSUSE camps that try to fill the media to the brim. Well, anyway, whatever you see missing should be available in the repositories online.

By the way, the small size of

Constantine!

default IM client. This essentially means, you can now use voice chat and Web cams while using Google chat.

- A preview version of GNOME Shell (what could become the default UI in GNOME 3.0) is available in the repo.
- GNote replaces Tomboy as the note-taking application. The good part about GNote is it's written using C++ and not Mono. It's installed by default :-)
- RPMs use XZ compression instead of CPIO. In layman terms, this means smaller package sizes.
- Various enhancements to the virtualisation stack that you can read about in the article titled 'Virtualisation Features in Fedora 12'.

That's more or less what I figured was important from a desktop user's perspective. Anyhow, let's take a ride...

The media

Fedora 12 was officially released as a GNOME-based live CD. Of course, for KDE users there's a KDE live CD too. Now, after trying the live CDs during the last release, and not being at all satisfied by the lack of tools available, by default

the official Fedora DVD had one advantage. The DVD had some room left, and Rahul Sundaram (of Fedora fame) rolled out his Fedora 12 Remix (dubbed Omega) right on time for the LFY CD team to include that as an ISO image on the DVD. You need to burn the 1.2 GB image to a DVD, or copy it using the *dd* command to an empty thumb drive of at least 2 GB size.

After having used the Omega 12 live OS for a while, I'd say, this is the release for you, if:

1. You are a GNOME user and want a general-purpose desktop OS.
2. You want multimedia to work out-of-the-box.
3. You depend on an office suite (OpenOffice.org is missing in the Fedora 12 live CD).
4. RPM Fusion and Adobe repos are configured by default. This helps in easily installing the Flash Player, ATI/NVIDIA graphics drivers, as well as extra software that Fedora officially doesn't support.

So, overall it's less work for you after installation. By the way, Rahul has written an article on how to create your own Fedora Remixes, which has also been published in this issue.

The machines

Like all distros, I test drove Fedora 12 on the two systems at my disposal.

1. An assembled AMD desktop:
 - AMD Athlon X2 5600+ Dual Core (2.8 GHz, 2000 MHz HyperTransport, 1 MB L2 cache)
 - 2 GB 800 MHz DDR2 SDRAM
 - 250 GB 7200 rpm SATA + 160GB 7200 rpm PATA
 - NVIDIA 7050 PV (integrated graphics inside an ASUS M2N-VM DVI MoBo)
 - LG CRT monitor (700E) with a max screen resolution of 1280x1024 pixels
2. A HP 550 laptop:
 - Intel Core 2 Duo T5470 (1.6 GHz, 800 MHz FSB, 2 MB L2 cache)
 - 1 GB 667 MHz DDR2 SDRAM
 - 160 GB 5400 rpm SATA
 - Mobile Intel GMA X3100 graphics
 - 15.4-inch (39.1 cm) wide screen display with a max resolution of 1200x800 pixels

The Anaconda

Well, yes, that's the Fedora installer that powers both the installation DVD, as well as the live CDs. If you're a seasoned Fedora user, there's not much to report here. It looks and works the same. It's one of the easiest installers around, though it's perhaps still dogged by the same bug/feature that ensures if one package fails to install (due to a defective media, or whatever reason), you can't continue further. Imagine if it happens when you're almost done installing Fedora :-O

Anyway, the installations on my systems went smoothly. Installing the default system offered by the Fedora DVD, and adding in the KDE and virtualisation package sets, plus Thunderbird, took around 23 minutes to complete on my desktop.



Note: The media check utility that comes up before you begin installation, reports "Unable to read the disc checksum from the